

THE

Geriatrician's Guide

YOUR SCORING TOOL

The Community Scorecard

A tool for evaluating and comparing senior living communities — built from what I notice when I walk in, so you know what to look for.



Michael D. Genualdi, MD
Board-Certified in Geriatrics & Internal Medicine

*No placement commissions.
No facility money. Ever.*

HOW THIS WORKS

One Scorecard for each community. One Summary for the decision.

Use the Tour Notes to capture what you see while you're walking the building. Then print one Scorecard for each community, plus one Comparison Summary. Transcribe your notes into the Scorecard the same day — ideally within an hour of leaving, while the details are fresh.

COMMUNITY NAME

DATE OF TOUR

LEVEL(S) OF CARE

WHO LED THE TOUR

WHO CAME WITH YOU

HOW TO USE THE SCORES



Confident



Uncertain or N/A



Concerning

Rate each line as you go. Then give each section a single score from **1 to 5** — where 1 is a serious concern and 5 is full confidence. **Care capability outweighs the rest.** These scores help you compare communities side by side — they don't add up to a winner. Where the scores and your gut diverge, treat it as a signal to go back and dig.

Disclaimer: The information provided in this guide is for general educational purposes only and **DOES NOT CONSTITUTE MEDICAL ADVICE**, psychological advice, or legal advice. Reading or using this material does not establish a physician-patient relationship with Dr. Michael Genualdi or The Geriatrician's Guide LLC. You should always consult with your own qualified healthcare provider or medical professional regarding any specific medical conditions, symptoms, or senior care decisions.

01 Care Capability, Now and Later

DINING	RATING ✓ ~ ✗
Saw a meal actually served	☐
Medical diets (diabetic, low-sodium, renal) handled routinely	☐
Texture-modified food and thickened liquids for dysphagia — difficulty swallowing	☐
Routine weights taken, with a plan to act on weight loss or low intake	☐
Registered dietitian involved	☐
ENVIRONMENT	
Clean and odor-free, including off the tour route	☐
Bright, even lighting; secure handrails; level floors	☐
Saw a real unit, not the model	☐
Bathroom safety — grab bars, step-free shower, room to assist	☐
Accessible now and as mobility declines — elevators, ramps, wide doorways	☐
RESPONDING TO CHANGING NEEDS	
Who responds when a resident falls or has an urgent need, and their training	☐
Sound judgment about when to send to the ER	☐
Can keep your loved one as care needs rise	☐
If on-site medical care is offered, how strong is it	☐
Reviewed current care needs with care director; community equipped to handle them	☐
How the service plan is created and kept current	☐

01 Care Capability, continued

MEDICATIONS	RATING ✓ ~ X
Process for handling medication questions or concerns, and how fast they're escalated	☐
Medication changes tracked and reconciled after every appointment or hospital stay	☐
PRN ("as-needed") medication monitored, especially for residents who can't report symptoms	☐
Reliable pharmacy with a plan to prevent gaps in medication	☐
ACTIVITIES AND ENGAGEMENT	
Varied programming that actually happens	☐
Residents engaged, not isolated in their rooms	☐
Notices and responds when a resident withdraws	☐
MEMORY CARE	
Secured unit backed by staff presence, not just the lock	☐
Agitation met with redirection, not medication first	☐
Staff engaged with residents, not clustered at the desk	☐
A calming environment — orientation cues, lighting, low noise	☐
Dementia training program named and specific	☐

Care Capability Score

1

2

3

4

5

02 Staffing

RATING

✓ ~ ✗

Enough staff overnight and weekends, not just midday	☐
Call buttons answered promptly, including overnight	☐
Low caregiver turnover; familiar faces stay	☐
Stable clinical leadership — director in the role a year or more	☐

Staffing Score

1 2 3 4 5

03 Safety Record

RATING

✓ ~ ✗

Clean licensing and inspection history	☐
Owns past citations plainly — what happened, what changed	☐

Safety Record Score

1 2 3 4 5

04 Cost Transparency

RATING

✓ ~ ✗

Full fee schedule in writing — base rate, care tiers, extras	☐
How care level is assessed, and how often	☐
What the move-in fee covers, and what's refundable	☐
Rate-increase history, and any cap on yearly increases	☐
What could get your loved one asked to leave, and the notice required	☐
Medicaid or long-term care insurance accepted, if you'll need it	☐

Cost Transparency Score

1 2 3 4 5

05 Location and Access

RATING

✓ ~ ✗

Close enough that the people who matter will actually visit	☐
Reasonable distance to current doctors and familiar surroundings	☐
Neighborhood feels safe and pleasant	☐
Transportation for appointments and outings	☐

Location and Access Score

1

2

3

4

5

06 Culture and Communication

RATING

✓ ~ ✗

Staff knock and wait before entering rooms	☐
Kindness that holds when no one's performing for you	☐
Spoke with a resident, not just staff	☐
Hard questions welcomed, and free to speak with staff alone	☐
Clear grievance process; ombudsman known or posted	☐
Keeps families in the loop proactively, not just when there's a problem	☐

Culture and Communication Score

1

2

3

4

5

07 Fit for Your Loved One Specifically

RATING

✓ ~ ✗

A place they'd recognize as theirs — pace, people, feel	☐
Their interests and social style have a place here	☐
Food, faith, language, and culture they'd want are honored	☐
You can picture them through an ordinary day here	☐

Fit Score

1

2

3

4

5

AFTER THE TOUR

One thing that gave me confidence:

One thing that gave me pause:

One question I forgot to ask:

Follow-up needed:

ONE SHEET, ALL COMMUNITIES

Comparison Summary

Fill this in once, after every tour is scored. Transcribe each community's seven section scores into a column and read across, section by section. Care capability weighs most. Don't total the columns – the highest sum isn't the answer. Where the scores and your gut disagree, that's the signal to go back and dig.

SECTION	COMMUNITY 1	COMMUNITY 2	COMMUNITY 3	COMMUNITY 4
Community Name				
Care Capability				
Staffing				
Safety Record				
Cost Transparency				
Location & Access				
Culture & Communication				
Fit For Your Loved One				
Overall				

Where I'm leaning, and why: